

Psalms 148

Praise from the Heavens

Praise ye him, sun and moon: praise him, all ye stars of light
KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 Praise ye the LORD. Praise ye the LORD from the heavens: praise him in the heights.
- 2 Praise ye him, all his angels: praise ye him, all his hosts.
- 3 Praise ye him, sun and moon: praise him, all ye stars of light.
- 4 Praise him, ye heavens of heavens, and ye waters that be above the heavens.
- 5 Let them praise the name of the LORD: for he commanded, and they were created.
- 6 He hath also stablished them for ever and ever: he hath made a decree which shall not pass.
- 7 Praise the LORD from the earth, ye dragons, and all deeps:
- 8 Fire, and hail; snow, and vapours; stormy wind fulfilling his word:
- 9 Mountains, and all hills; fruitful trees, and all cedars:
- 10 Beasts, and all cattle; creeping things, and flying fowl:
- 11 Kings of the earth, and all people; princes, and all judges of the earth:
- 12 Both young men, and maidens; old men, and children:
- 13 Let them praise the name of the LORD: for his name alone is excellent; his glory is above the earth and heaven.
- 14 He also exalteth the horn of his people, the praise of all his saints; even of the children of Israel, a people near unto him.
Praise ye the LORD.

2 · CONTEXT

Psalm 148 calls the entire created order, from angels and celestial bodies down to weather, mountains, animals, and every rank of human society, to join in a single unified act of praise. Its sweeping structure—heavens first, then earth—pictures worship as woven into the fabric of creation itself, not limited to conscious human choice. Henry reads it as an invitation for people to recognize their praise as joining a chorus already underway rather than initiating something new.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-4

The call to praise begins in the heavens: angels, heavenly hosts, sun and moon, every star of light, the very heavens of heavens and the waters above the heavens are all summoned to praise the Lord's name.

Verse 5-6

The reason given is creation itself: let them praise the name of the Lord, for He commanded and they were created, established forever by a decree that will never pass away—existence itself framed as an act calling for praise.

Verse 7-10

Praise then descends to earth: sea creatures and ocean depths, fire and hail, snow and clouds, stormy wind fulfilling His word, mountains and hills, fruitful trees and cedars, wild animals and cattle, creeping things and flying birds—the whole visible world summoned together.

Verse 11-14

Human society joins last, across every rank: kings and all peoples, princes and judges, young men and women, old men and children together—praising a name that is excellent above the earth and whose glory is above heaven. God is said to have exalted the horn of His people, giving praise to all His saints, the children of Israel, a people near to Him.

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

Creation, in this psalm's vision, is not a silent backdrop to human worship but an active participant already engaged in praise, from angels and stars down to weather and animals. Human beings, across every social rank, are called to add their voices to a chorus that spans the entire created order rather than to originate praise on their own.

Application for life today.

Let this psalm change how you notice creation—sunrise, weather, animals—by seeing it as already engaged in praise rather than as mere scenery for your own concerns. Notice the psalm's inclusion of every rank of society, from kings to children, and consider who around you might feel excluded from praise whom this psalm actively includes. Practice joining, rather than initiating, worship—approaching praise as adding your voice to something already vast and underway.

5 · REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. How does seeing creation as already engaged in praise—sun, weather, animals—change the way you notice the world around you day to day?

2. This psalm includes every rank of society in praise, from kings to children; who around you might need to be actively invited into worship that they currently feel excluded from?

3. What would it mean, practically, to approach your own praise as joining a chorus already underway rather than something you have to originate on your own?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).